

Joshua Ferrer

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

American University Assistant Professor, Government	2025–Present
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EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles Ph.D., Political Science (2025) M.A., Political Science (2022)	2020–2025
University of Otago / Te Whare Wānanga o Otāgo M.A. with Distinction, Politics	2019–2020
Amherst College B.A. with Distinction, Political Science and Music, <i>Summa Cum Laude</i> , <i>Phi Beta Kappa</i>	2013–2017
Worcester College, Oxford University Visiting Student in Politics	2016

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Election administration, representation, local and state politics, voter turnout, primary elections

PUBLISHED ARTICLES

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- Does Leader Turnover Degrade Local Government Performance? Evidence from Local Election Officials. (Forthcoming, *American Journal of Political Science*). With Daniel M. Thompson.
- Ferrer, Joshua. 2025. “To Elect or Appoint? Evidence from Local Election Administration.” *Quarterly Journal of Political Science*. DOI: 10.1561/100.00023193
- Urban Affairs Review Best Paper on Urban and Regional Politics Presented at the 2024 APSA Meeting - Honorable Mention
 - CUSP Working Paper Series in American Politics selection
- Carnes, Nicholas, Joshua Ferrer, Miriam Golden, Esme Lillywhite, Noam Lupu, and Eugenia Nazrullaeva. 2025. “The Global Legislators Database: Characteristics of National Legislators in the World’s Democracies.” *British Journal of Political Science*. DOI: 10.1017/S000712342400053X
- APSA Comparative Politics Section’s Lijphart/Przeworski/Verba Dataset Award.
- Ferrer, Joshua and Christopher Palmisano. 2025. “Beyond the Trump Presidency: The Racial Underpinnings of White Americans’ Anti-Democratic Beliefs.” *Journal of Race, Ethnicity, and Politics*. DOI: 10.1017/rep.2025.1

- Ferrer, Joshua, Igor Geyn, and Daniel M. Thompson. 2024. "How Partisan is Local Election Administration?" *American Political Science Review*. DOI: 10.1017/S0003055423000631
- Barreto, Matt, Claudia Alegre, Isaiah Bailey, Alexandria Davis, Joshua Ferrer, Joyce Nguy, Christopher Palmisano, and Crystal Robertson. 2024. "Black Lives Matter and the Racialized Support for the January 6 Insurrection." *Annals of the American Academy of Political and Social Science*. DOI: 10.1177/00027162241228395
- Ferrer, Joshua. 2022. "The Effects of Proportional Representation on Election Lawmaking: Evidence from New Zealand." *Representation*. DOI: 10.1080/00344893.2022.2032292
- Ferrer, Joshua. 2021. "Re-evaluating Consensus in New Zealand Election Reform." *Political Science*. DOI: 10.1080/00323187.2020.1859337

PUBLISHED BOOK CHAPTERS

- Ferrer, Joshua and Igor Geyn. 2024. "Electing America's Election Officials," in *Local Election Administrators in the United States: The Frontline of Democracy*, Paul Gronke, David Kimball, Thessalia Merivaki, Mara Suttman-Lea, Christian Grose, and Bridgett King, ed. New York: Palgrave Macmillan.

WORKING PAPERS

- Are Fewer Elections Better Elections? The Impact of On-Cycle Elections on the Electoral Experience. With Zoltan Hajnal (Under Review)
- Partisanship in Local Bureaucratic Appointments: Evidence from Election Administration. (Under Review)
- The Effect of Workload on Public Official Retention: Evidence from Local Election Officials. (Under Review)
- Do Local Election Officials Represent Their Constituents?
- The Effect of Partisan Primaries on Turnout and Representation.
- Are Election Reforms Passed Democratically? Evidence from New Zealand.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS AND REPORTS

- Election Official Turnover Rates through the 2024 Election. *Bipartisan Policy Center*. 2025.
- The Effect of Open Primaries on Turnout and Representation (with Michael Thorning and J.D. Rackey). *Bipartisan Policy Center*. 2024.
- Election Official Turnover Rates from 2000-2024 (with Daniel M. Thompson and Rachel Orey). *Bipartisan Policy Center*. 2024.
- Contested Killings Replication: A Comment on Morris and Shoub (2023) (with Jacques Courbe and Graham Straus). *Institute for Replication (I4R)*. 2024.
- 2022 Primary Turnout: Trends and Lessons for Boosting Participation (with Michael Thorning). *Bipartisan Policy Center*. 2023.
- Online Political Campaigning in New Zealand. *Transparency International New Zealand*. 2020.
- 2018 Primary Turnout and Reforms (with John Fortier, Michael Thorning, and Matthew Weil). *Bipartisan Policy Center*. 2018.

NEWS AND BLOGS

What Would Election Consolidation Mean for Local Election Officials in South Carolina?. *Bipartisan Policy Center*. 2025.

Partisan or Not? Local Election Officials Don't Tilt Elections in Favor of Their Party's Candidates. *The Conversation*. 2022.

Did Last Year's Black Lives Matter Protests Push Cities to Defund Police? Yes and No. (with Joyce Nguy). *Washington Post*. 2021.

Consensus-Based NZ Electoral Reform Is a Lovely Idea. And It's Mostly a Myth. *The Spinoff*. 2020.

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

Pathways to Primary Election Reform, USC Schwarzenegger and Unite America Institute, June 2026

University of Maryland Center for Democracy and Civic Engagement, Dec 2025

Institute for Election Administration, Research, and Practice, Auburn University, Nov 2025

Dept of Political Science, Claremont Graduate University, Sept 2024

PROFESSIONAL CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2026, 2025, 2024 (organized panel), 2023 and 2022

Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2026, 2023 and 2022

Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2026 (co-organized Election Sciences CWC), 2025, 2024, and 2022

Election Science, Reform, and Administration Conference, 2026, 2024, 2023, 2022, and 2021

Keeping the Republic Conference, Notre Dame, 2025 and 2023

SoCal Political Institutions and Political Economy Conference, 2024 (Caltech), 2024 (CGU), 2023

Local Political Economy APSA Pre-Conference, 2024

Primary Election Research Symposium, 2024

UCLA January 6 CMPS Conference, 2024

New Zealand Political Studies Association Annual Meeting, 2019

GRANTS AND AWARDS

APSA Urban and Local Politics Section Best Dissertation Award, 2026

Election Reform Research Agenda RFP, Unite America Institute, 2026 (\$80,521 + \$10,000 addition)

Public Affairs and Policy Lab, American University School of Public Affairs, 2026 (\$1,000 + \$3,000 student RA funding)

SPSA Artinian Travel Award, 2026 (\$500)

Dissertation Year Fellowship Award, University of California, Los Angeles, 2024-2025 (\$20,000)

APSA Representation and Electoral Systems Graduate Student Research Grant, 2024 (\$1,000)

Election Workforce Grant, Bipartisan Policy Center, 2024 (\$37,000)
Partisan Primaries Research Grant, Unite America Institute, 2024 (\$20,000)
Political Psychology Fellowship, University of California, Los Angeles, 2023 (\$2,000)
Graduate Research Mentorship, University of California, Los Angeles, 2021-2022 (\$20,000)
Graduate Summer Research Mentorship, University of California, Los Angeles, 2021 (\$6,000)
Alumni Fellowship, University of California, Los Angeles, 2020-2021 (\$20,000)
Yaman Didem MA Thesis Prize for best thesis in Politics, University of Otago, 2020
New Zealand Politics Postgraduate Paper Prize, New Zealand Political Studies Association, 2019
Fulbright Graduate Student Award to New Zealand, 2019

TEACHING

American University, Assistant Professor:

Politics in the U.S., Fall 2026 and 2025

Political Analysis, Fall 2026

UCLA, Instructor of Record:

Intro to American Politics (Summer Institute), 2024

UCLA, TA:

National Institutions: Congress, 2024

Intro to American Politics, 2023 and 2022

Political Parties and American Democracy, 2023

Undergraduate Research Experience, 2022–present

University of Otago, Departmental Tutor:

Politics of the European Union, 2019.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Reviewer: *American Journal of Political Science*, *Election Law Journal*, *Journal of Race, Ethnicity, and Politics*, *Party Politics*, *Perspectives on Politics*, *Political Behavior*, *PS: Political Science and Politics*, *Representation*, Routledge, *State and Local Government Review*, *Journal of Election Administration*, *Research and Practice*, *Frontiers in Political Science*, section *Peace and Democracy*, *Frontiers in Political Science*, section *Elections and Representation*

SELECTED PREVIOUS EXPERIENCE

Consultant, Bipartisan Policy Center.	2022–Present
Domestic Policy Council Intern, The White House.	2015